spending. Playing county cricket is not just a great experience in terms of learning your craft as a cricketer – it's also financially lucrative. At Glamorgan, where I am contracted, the guys are clocking in the region of £70 000 a season. That's good money right there, and it doesn't come back to South Africa; along with my IPL earnings, my county cricket money stays in the UK.

I've also had – and still have – a great relationship with my sponsors. Apart from being given great clothing and equipment, it has also been pretty lucrative cash-wise. I like to think that I give my sponsors' brands plenty of exposure too. I know this is going to sound like one big punt, but I've been lucky to work with a number of brands whose products and ethos I've really loved and with which I've identified.

Take Puma, for example; they are one of my main sponsors. I moved to Puma from Adidas before the 2003 World Cup, which took place here in South Africa. I'd been with Adidas for ages – from school, even – but our relationship was getting a little stale and they seemed to be focusing more on Jacques Kallis and Mark Boucher than me. That was their prerogative, I guess, but Puma were really interested in building a relationship with me and now we've got a really good thing going. I've always loved their stuff – I reckon Puma's technical and lifestyle ranges are the best you get, and I get to wear it every day of my life, which is cool by me.

Because I'm sample size, I am basically given free rein to take whatever I want from their sample stockroom – I've literally got cupboards full of Puma stuff. I've become a lot more selective these days, though. Obviously I'm a little bit older now, so I don't want to wear the same clothing as my younger Puma-sponsored Proteas teammates, JP Duminy and Albie Morkel. I love, for example, Puma's formal Black Label range – flipping classy stuff. Puma are also prepared to push the envelope a little with their design, which really appeals to me. I mean, they made me this wicked pair of black and silver boots specifically for the Deccan Chargers, which they also sponsor.

An International Cricket Council (ICC) rule states that your boots have to be predominantly white – which, frankly, I've always found a little strange. In limited-over games you wear coloured clothing, pads and gloves … but still your shoes have to be white? Fortunately, the IPL doesn't subscribe to the ICC's rules and we're allowed to wear boots that match our outfit's colours.